

ened. When he did consciousness returned abruptly; in a second he was wide awake and our conference was resumed with no reference being made to Mr. Morgan's nap.

We were not always so gentle in those harsh days. I recall as if it were an act in a melodrama a day in November, when a group of us gathered for a meeting in a private office in the Trust Company of America Building. We were the directors of the Norfolk & Southern Railway. The road was in difficulties, as were most railroad corporations. The problem could be expressed always in one way: cash. We were there to go through the legal formalities necessary to authorize the issuance of a mortgage for \$25,000,000. The shareholders had given their approval.

Among those present was Oakleigh Thorne, president of the Trust Company of America. He was as restless as a cat detained from its basket of mewing kittens; downstairs were many things demanding his attention. Who could say what bad news there might be coughing out of the stock-ticker? At any minute that menacing line of depositors might begin again to extend itself into the street to grow monstrously until it would be giving off a wave of hysteria, having repercussions all over the country.

As the lawyer lifted papers from his bag in preparation for the reading of the mortgage, there was a little talk of the latest gossip out of the Knickerbocker Trust Company mess. Most of us there knew, and had an affection for, John T. Barney who had been its president. Some were inclined to blame Charles W. Morse or F. Augustus Heintze for Barney's difficulties. Then the lawyer began his *pro forma* reading.

While he was in the midst of its dull phrases a telephone bell rang and, as Oakleigh Thorne answered it, the lawyer stopped reading.

"Barney has committed suicide," said Thorne. "Shot himself with a pistol."

No one commented. The lawyer went on reading. That was not callousness. We simply had no time to express our feelings. At that moment the battle was on; we were in it.